



Propagate field properties: This feature allows you to modify a field property in one place and propagate that new value to all controls that are bound to that same field. Anyone that develops Access applications will appreciate how easy it is now to propagate properties set on a table to all of its related forms and reports. In the past, developers had to go through each related object and set the property manually—at the risk of forgetting some. This feature greatly reduces that risk as well as the time consumed by this task.

Whenever you modify a property that is inherited on a field, when in the Table Design view, Access will display the 'Property Update Options' Smart tag that offers an option to "Update <property name> everywhere <field name> is used."



Shared data: Sharing is simplified by presenting shared data right along with a user's own data. For instance, you can view other calendars to which you have access, right next to your own calendar.

Expand distribution lists: Distribution Lists can now be expanded to display the names of the people on the list. This makes it easy to add or remove a few names before sending, without having to modify the distribution list or start from a scratch when addressing an e-mail message.

Block external content: By default, Outlook 2003 helps protect the privacy of its users, and provides them with more

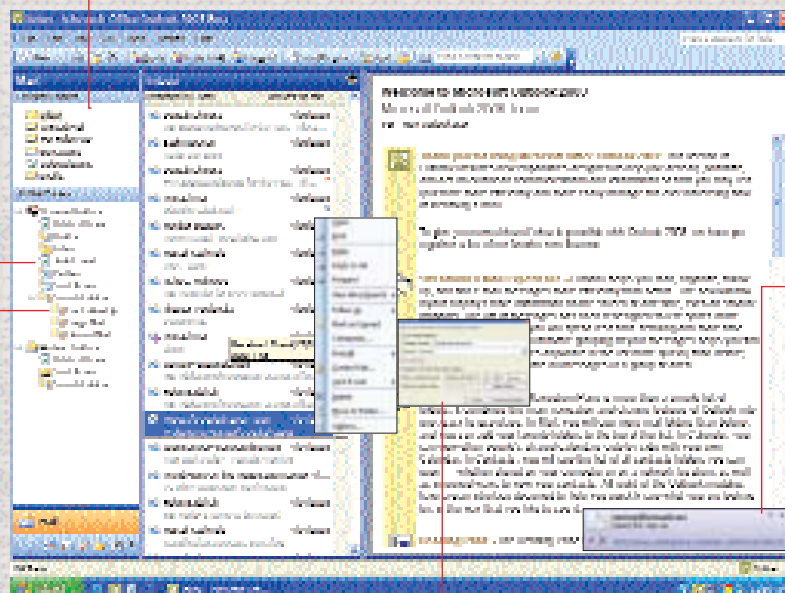
control over the information in their inbox, through a feature called Block External Content. If an e-mail message tries to connect unannounced to a Web server on the Internet, Outlook 2003



External content settings in Outlook 2003

Junk e-mail filter: Outlook's new junk e-mail filters evaluate whether a message should be treated as junk based on several factors, such as the time it was sent and its contents. You can still create a Trusted and Junk Sender list that will supersede the decisions made by automatic filtering.

Navigation Pane: The Navigation Pane is designed to build more efficiency into Outlook by combining the main navigation and sharing aspects of the application into one easy-to-use pane. With the Navigation Pane, users get more relevant and context-sensitive navigation through Outlook and not simply a static list of folders.



Search Folders: With the introduction of these new folders, Keeping track of mail that satisfies a complex search criteria is easy. You could set up a folder that keeps track of all mails to a certain account that contain interesting words, for example. Some sample folders are created by default.

New mail desktop alert: An all-new alert feature is incorporated in Outlook 2003, which pops up on receiving a new e-mail. It contains buttons to open, flag or delete the e-mail message, and fades out just as subtly as it faded in if it's ignored

Outlook rules and alerts Improvements: The experience for creating new rules has been streamlined and made easier for common rules, making it easier for people to stay organised using simple inbox rules, and to view and change rules once they're created. Common rule actions can be viewed graphically and modified quickly. In addition, users can associate alerts with their rules to stay abreast of current information

Hide when minimized: At last Microsoft includes a feature, that was much needed by regular users. Outlook does not appear in the taskbar when its main window has been minimized. Instead, Outlook disappears into the notification area, still collecting messages and waiting for the user to double-click the icon and bring Outlook back